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daniel-dickson.org (Portfolio)

www.fieldofaction.org (Other)

Top Skills

Creative Direction

Brand Systems

Design Systems

Languages

English

Honors-Awards

Emmy Award

Certificate of Typographic
Excellence

4th Typography Annual 2013

Gold BDA

52nd Design Annual

Alfred (Daniel) Dickson II

Creative Director · Brand systems & product surfaces

Los Angeles, California, United States

Summary

For 15+ years I've done one thing across a lot of different rooms: build the conditions that let creative work hold together. Nickelodeon, Tribeca, Vevo, Google Cloud, Apple Music, now Apple TV Sports. The brief changed every time. The work underneath stayed the same: take something complex and in motion, a launch, a platform, a company changing shape, and give it enough structure that a team can move with clarity. Brand systems, product surfaces, the narratives leadership stands behind, the live moments an audience actually feels. I've come to call this design infrastructure: I set the field the work comes from. In practice that means giving a team enough shared framing to move in the same direction, protecting their focus so the craft holds up under deadline, and staying with the work long enough that trust builds across the people it passes through. It's the structural side of the job, and the part that tends to still be standing after the launch energy fades. I develop this as a practice under Field of Action and write it down at Art of Memos. What holds my attention now is the seam where technology, creativity, and human understanding meet: how organizations make complex systems legible, and how a creative leader makes the conditions for ambitious work.

Experience

Apple

Creative Director, Apple

June 2021 - Present (5 years 1 month)

Los Angeles, CA

Lead brand, product-surface, and production design systems across Apple Music and Apple TV Sports. Set creative direction for high-visibility launches, partner work, and live sports surfaces. Build the modular systems that keep the work coherent as it scales across teams and channels.

Partner across product, marketing, production, and editorial to turn complex content into experiences an audience reads instantly, and build the frameworks and operating practices that let distributed teams move with shared intent instead of constant re-briefing.

Google Cloud

Design Director, Google Cloud

April 2019 - June 2021 (2 years 3 months)

San Francisco Bay Area

Led brand and storytelling systems for Google Cloud across enterprise cloud, AI, infrastructure, and digital-transformation narratives. Partnered with marketing, sales, product, and executive teams to translate deep technical complexity into creative systems, campaigns, and go-to-market storytelling that both cloud-native and traditional enterprise audiences could actually follow.

Helped modernize how Google Cloud showed up. Sharpening clarity, consistency, and trust across a wide field of B2B communication.

Universal Kids

Interim Creative Director, Brand Design

January 2019 - April 2019 (4 months)

New York

Vevo

Creative Director, Brand and Marketing

May 2015 - January 2019 (3 years 9 months)

New York City Metropolitan Area

Led brand and marketing creative across artist franchises, original programming, product, and internal communications. Building the systems and team practices that let a high-volume music-video platform show up consistently in a fast-moving business.

Tribeca Enterprises

Creative Director

August 2012 - December 2014 (2 years 5 months)

New York City Metropolitan Area

Directed experience and brand design across Tribeca Film Festival, Tribeca Film, and Tribeca Studios campaigns, live events, and editorial. Unifying a multi-arm cultural institution under one coherent creative system.

Nickelodeon

Art Director

October 2009 - August 2012 (2 years 11 months)

1515 Broadway

Art-directed broadcast motion and brand campaigns, including Kids' Choice Awards and World Wide Day of Play.

Noise

Art Director/Designer

February 2008 - September 2009 (1 year 8 months)

New York City Metropolitan Area

Agency art direction and design for Puma, Sears, and Thompson Hotels.

Nickelodeon Brand Group

Senior Designer

October 2005 - January 2008 (2 years 4 months)

New York City Metropolitan Area

Design and art direction across brand, experience, and marketing. Including a record-setting Kids' Choice Awards and lead design on the NickToons book.

Cartoon Network

Designer

2003 - 2005 (2 years)

Atlanta Metropolitan Area

Brand and marketing design, including the Camp Lazlo launch and an early "Brand News" sales-enablement system for the Warner Bros. team.

Education

Georgia State University

BFA, Graphic Design · (1995 - 1999)

Yale University - Yale School of Management

Business Perspectives for Creative Leaders · (2012)